



GRIMES COUNTY BUDGET HEARINGS

OFFICIAL MINUTES — FRIDAY, JULY 31, 2026

The Grimes County Budget Hearings met on Friday, July 31, 2026, at 9:00 A.M. Members Present: County Judge Joe Fauth, Commissioner Chad Mallett, Commissioner David Tullos, Commissioner Michael Raska, Commissioner Phillip Cox.

County Judge Joe Fauth called the meeting to order.

Discuss and review the Grimes County FY 2027 departmental budget requests. — Joe Fauth III

County Judge Joe Fauth opened the meeting by calling the Commissioners Court to order at 9:02 a.m. on July 31, 2026, noting that the next day would mark the beginning of August. The court reviewed multiple departmental budgets, beginning with the Human Resources department's request for a new uniform line item of \$250, which County Auditor Jessi Murphy agreed to create as line 4428. Tax Assessor/Collector Mary Ann Waters presented budget adjustments for the Historical Commission on behalf of Chairman Kathy Wells, proposing the creation of a rentals and contract line for \$2,600 to cover storage unit costs, reducing operating expenses from \$1,500 to zero, adjusting other expenses to \$543.30, and establishing a repairs and maintenance line for \$1,000. The commission also proposed reducing a capital improvements line from \$250,000 to \$60,000 for pavilion construction and Steinhagen Museum restoration work, while adding \$250,000 for a building purchase to provide workspace for cataloging and organizing historical materials. Commissioner David Tullos expressed concern about spending all available funds from the Becker house sale in a single budget year, cautioning that the historical commission had historically struggled with participation and fundraising and would return to having no funds once these monies were exhausted. Judge Fauth acknowledged the concern but noted that budgeting these amounts allowed the court to revisit the decision later if circumstances changed, and emphasized the practical need for workspace to enable the commission's work. Waters explained the commission's strategy to generate ongoing revenue by opening the Steinhagen House as a museum with admission fees and donations, and by holding fundraising events once facilities were operational. The court then reviewed the county judge's budget. Matt Pfeifer presented the Agrilife Extension Agents budget. IT Director Gregg Cannon discussed more on his budget. Fire Chief Jason Katkoski was present for Navasota Fire Department. Judge Fauth stated the County has contributed \$115,000 in the past. The Judge has put \$150,000 in the proposed budget. Chief Katkoski is asking for \$175,000. Discussion among the Commissioners and they agreed that Navasota FD has the knowledge and expertise to assist the surrounding Volunteer Fire Departments when needed. Katrina DeWalt had a brief discussion concerning Adult Probation's budget. EMC/Fire Marshal Dione Bumpous was available to speak about hiring someone for her office that would free her up to pursue the qualifications needed to keep the fees that what is within the Development pipeline currently, just the things that are in for permitting with our fee schedule and calculating square footage the County could collect approximately \$800,000. The revenues could be maintained in house and would not go into the County and back out to a consulting firm or code compliance firm. Various revenue and fee-related matters, including discussion of court costs from justice of the peace and municipal court appeals that County Clerk Barbara Kimich confirmed were being processed through the

civil side with assistance from LGS.

ADJOURNMENT

A motion to adjourn the meeting was made by Commissioner Raska. Seconded by Commissioner Mallett. Carried. (5-0-0) The meeting adjourned at 12:06 PM.

*THE OFFICIAL MINUTES OF THE GRIMES COUNTY BUDGET HEARINGS ON July 31st, 2026, ARE
HEREBY APPROVED.*

Barbara Kimich County Clerk